

Avoid Internet Scams

That is the infographic which gives the information about various scams and safety tips to avoid them.
<http://dgit.in/LgJwSS>

**Why iOS 6 may fail?**

Lots of disappointment from iOS 6 first beta update. That is why it may fail!
<http://dgit.in/Kvweh0>

Flame & Stuxnet: World War Revised

Quick advances in cyber-warfare may soon lead to a new class of war with “cyber- weapons”. Security experts at Kaspersky Lab in Russia, during an investigation prompted by International Telecommunication Union discovered a new malicious program, Flame. The computer virus experts seem to think that it’s a government backed-program, because of the likely cost of such a sophisticated endeavour. Flame, which was actively used for cyber-espionage, was apparently targeted specifically at computers used in Iran, and other countries in the Middle East and North Africa.

According to experts, Flame can copy and steal data and audio files, turn on a computer microphone and record sounds in its proximity, take screen shots, read emails, and acquire passwords and logins. It can communicate with other computers in the vicinity via Bluetooth and locate their

whereabouts even without an Internet connection.

A previous malware known as Stuxnet, discovered in 2010 targeted computers in Natanz, Iran’s Uranium-enrichment facility. Experts from Kaspersky Lab said that there seems to be a link in both these malwares. Although they were developed and designated by two completely different groups, there is strong evidence that they shared source code of at least one module.

It’s widely believed that the United States, Israel or both were behind the development and deployment of Stuxnet. This time again the two nations have reportedly developed Flame to help slow Iran’s nuclear program.

At the cyber-security conference in Tel Aviv on June 6, 2012, Eugene Kaspersky, CEO of his namesake anti-virus company, condemned cyber-weapons and urged countries worldwide to work against it. He said, “Cyber boomerang may come back to you”. 

India ranks 14th in PC protection

In the present scenario where cyber-crime is on the rise and every day a new virus is set loose to harm our computers, there is good news for Indians. According to a study conducted by security software firm McAfee, Indians are more aware about basic PC protection than Americans, Chinese and even Japanese. India ranks 14th with 82.67 of computers equipped with basic security software

solution, despite the fact that the country has low penetration of computers. The study estimates India had a total installed base of more than 60 million PCs by the end of 2011. Basic security protection includes anti-virus, anti-spyware and firewall technologies. Finland leads with 90.3 percent of its PCs wielding basic security protection, followed by Italy (86.2 percent) and Germany (85.55 percent). 

LinkedIn hacked: Is your account safe?

In another such cyber-space infringement, about 6.5 million passwords of accounts on the social networking website LinkedIn were encrypted and posted on an online forum based in Russia. The file only contains passwords hashed using the SHA-1 algorithm

does not appear to be the case with these leaked passwords.

Vicente Silveira, director of LinkedIn said that they will add an additional layer of security to its accounts and members whose passwords were leaked will find their account password invalid. They will receive an email from LinkedIn with instructions on



without the corresponding email logins. An SHA-1 hash is an algorithm that converts your password into a unique set of numbers and letters. Often, random bits are added to a hash, known as ‘salting’, which greatly increases the time and efforts needed to crack the encrypted passwords. But that

how to set their passwords. The company said all passwords in the current database are now “salted”. They claim that there have been no reports of accounts compromised by password theft. However, LinkedIn is being sued for \$5 million by an Illinois based woman named Katie Szpyrka over the security breach. 

Smart TVs to have anti-virus software

All the cyber threats that we are vulnerable to, they are no longer limited to computers with more and more electronic devices- smart-phones, tablets- thriving on the internet. Most new TVs and set-top boxes will soon be internet-

ready, support web surfing, download applications and run remote applications, exposing them to potential viruses and other malware. Ocean Blue Software and Sophos have joined hands to develop a cloud-based anti-virus software to defend your Smart TVs from this potential cyber threat. Such anti-virus software is also expected to bolster people’s confidence in e-commerce and other internet based transactions that require you to fill personal information. 

